

Calling all students in grades 9 to 12!



Enter Schola Cantorum's 2026-2027 POETRY to MUSIC Contest

Picture your own words put to music and sung by one of Silicon Valley's most admired choirs!

Schola Cantorum is offering Santa Clara County students in grades 9 to 12 an opportunity to hear their poem turned into a musical composition that will be presented in concert by a large, auditioned, mixed-voice choir. The winning poem will be set to music by acclaimed composer Maria Thompson Corley. The world premiere will be sung in May 2027 under the direction of Schola's artistic director Buddy James.

- 2026 theme: *Belonging* (finding your place in the world)
- All poems must have a title (used for the new choral piece) and be 20 lines or fewer
- Use any rhyme scheme except free verse
- Your entry must be submitted by November 16th, 2026

THE DEADLINE IS FINAL: We need to allow our composer time to complete the work in time for the performance at Schola's concert on May 23, 2027. Our spring concert will feature the works of significant choral composers inspired by the poetry of William Shakespeare, Dylan Thomas, Sara Teasdale, and others.

Prizes!!

\$600 First Place • \$350 Second Place • \$250 Third Place

While only the first-place poem will be set to music, all prize winners will be featured in Schola Cantorum's publicity materials, programs, and on our website.

The contest will be judged by a panel of Santa Clara County's Poet Laureate, experienced Schola Cantorum members, and composer Maria Thompson Corley. The contest is open to all students in grades 9 to 12 in the fall of 2026 who reside or attend schools in Santa Clara County.

FOR ADDITIONAL INFORMATION
AND CONTEST ENTRY

go to: ScholaCantorum.org/poetry/

